

AKWAPIM RURAL BANK LIMITED



ANTI MONEY LAUNDERING POLICY/MANUAL

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POLICY/MANUAL ON ANTI-MONEY LAUNDERING (AML) AND COMBATING THE FINANCING OF TERRORISM (CFT) FOR AKUAPIM RURAL BANK LIMITED (ARB)

1.0 INTRODUCTION

- There is growing concern about the dangers posed by Money Laundering and other financial crimes to the stability and integrity of the fragile financial system in the country. Money Laundering evolves from a number of predicate offences, such as, illicit trafficking in narcotics and humans, corruption, terrorism, prostitution, illegal mining, tax evasion and other nefarious activities as well as financial crimes such as foreign exchange malpractices, bank fraud etc.
- Given the devastating effect this menace could have on the financial system and the national economy, the need to institute counter measures for money laundering cannot be over emphasized.
- Counter measures taken by the national authorities to contain these crimes have met with little success. This calls for stronger inter-agency collaboration to combat the menace. Thus, the need to strengthen the capacity of financial sector staff including staff of ARB to help in combating this monster cannot be over-emphasized.

2.0 DEFINITION

There are various definitions of money laundering one of which is: -

„A process by which criminals attempt to conceal the true origin and ownership of proceeds of their criminal activities. Converting “dirty money” from drug/human trafficking, fraud, robbery etc. through the banking system to look respectable. In effect using the banking system to **“wash dirty money to become clean”**,,

3.0 PURPOSE

The purpose of this Policy/Manual is to:

- Enhance the Bank’s ability to comply with anti-money laundering and the combating of the financing of terrorism laws and regulations,
- Enable the Bank to assist law enforcement agencies in combating money laundering and financing of terrorism

- Minimize the risk of the Bank's resources being used for improper purposes
- Ensure that the Bank is not used as conduit to perpetuate money laundering and terrorism financing.
- Provide the Bank's staff with the requisite knowledge and training to enable them identify suspicious transactions, and acting in accordance with international best practices and the Anti-Money laundering Act 2008, (Act 749), identify those people attempting to launder money and finance terrorism.
- Protect the Bank and her employees.

4.0 ROLES

A. BOARD/SENIOR MANAGEMENT

- Appoint an Anti-Money Laundering Reporting Officer (AMLRO) who shall be a senior member of staff.
- Develop and adopt policies indicating its commitment to comply with AML/CFT obligations under the relevant Acts and regulations to prevent any transaction that facilitates ML/TF activities
- Formulate and implement internal rules procedures and other controls that will deter criminals from using its facilities for money laundering and terrorism financing and to ensure that its obligations under the relevant laws and regulations are always complied with.
- Ensure the availability of adequate resources for the proper training of staff and implementation of risk systems including computer software to assist in oversight controls.

B. ANTI-MONEY LAUNDERING REPORTING OFFICER (AMLRO)

- Serve as a liaison officer with BoG, FIC and Apex Bank and a point of contact for all employees on issues relating to money laundering and terrorism financing.
- Develop an AML/CFT compliance programme
- Receive and vet suspicious/cash transaction reports (STR and CTR) from staff

- File suspicious and cash transaction reports with the Financial Intelligence Centre (FIC)
- Ensure the implementation of the bank's compliance programme
- Co-ordinate staff training in AML/CFT awareness, detection methods and reporting requirements

C. EMPLOYEES

Responsible for ensuring that they:

- Adhere to the bank's AML/CFT policy and procedures
- Obtain all documentary evidence as outlined for identifying customers of the bank
- Ensure that all suspicious activities are reported
- Know the internal procedures for making reports
- Know the possible effects for deciding not to report knowledge or suspicion in cases of money laundering
- Do not use their private accounts for the benefit of customers' business (you may unknowingly be directly involved in money laundering which makes it an intentional criminal offence)
- Make themselves available for awareness and training programmes on AML/CFT
- Decline potential and new relationships that do not appear to be legitimate
- Decline transactions offered by non-account holders that do not appear legitimate
- Regularly monitor established relationships which feature large or abnormal transactions
- Retain records in order to provide an audit trail and adequate evidence to the law enforcement agencies.
- Promptly report all suspicions and also provide full co-operation to the Law enforcement authorities to the extent required by regulations and the law.

5.0 PROCEDURES

A. Business Relationships

Procedures will be maintained in order to ensure that:

The identities of all persons conducting business with the Bank is properly verified and sufficient information gathered and recorded to enable the Bank to know its customer.

- Potential new relationships that do not appear to be legitimate are declined.
- Transactions offered by non-account holders that do not appear legitimate are declined.
- Established relationships are regularly monitored in respect of large or abnormal transactions.
- Records are retained for at least six (6) years to provide an audit trail and adequate evidence to the law enforcement agencies.
- All suspicions are promptly reported and full co-operation is to be provided to the Law enforcement authorities to the extent required by regulations and the law.

B. Branch Managers are responsible for the day-to-day compliance with money laundering obligations within those parts of the institutions for which they manage

C. The Board of Directors and Management are to:

- Develop necessary policies, procedures, training and education.
- Develop and maintain policy in line with evolving statutory and regulatory obligations and advice from enforcement agencies.
- Ensure that the Bank complies with the money laundering policy.

D. Employees are to:

- Remain vigilant to the possibility of money laundering.
- Report to the Anti-Money Laundering Reporting officer (AMLRO) all suspicions of money laundering.
- Comply fully with money laundering procedures in respect of client identification, account monitoring and record keeping

E. The AMLRO shall be responsible for:

- Checking whether there is adherence to policy and procedures on money laundering.

i. Education and Training

- Staff shall be conversant with the contents of the manual on Money Laundering and Combating the Financing of Terrorism.
- Staff shall receive initial and periodic refresher training on Money Laundering and Combating the Financing of Terrorism

ii. Money laundering seeks to cover up monetary gains obtained from criminal activities. Therefore,

- It is an offence to assist anyone you know or suspect to be laundering money.
- If a member of staff knows or suspects that a transaction is related to any crime they must report it to the AMLRO
- Disclosure to clients or anyone else that they are the subject of a report or that they are under investigations is an offence.
- ARB would put in place procedures to combat money laundering. These shall include:
 - Verification of new customer identification.
 - Retention of records
 - Recognition and reporting of suspicions of money laundering
 - Training of staff

6.0 KNOW YOUR CUSTOMER

It is important to ensure that sufficient information is acquired for all new accounts. The most fundamental requirement is to “know your customer”. Unless records are complete it is difficult to determine whether a transaction is legitimate, unusual or suspicious.

It is important to ensure that sufficient information is obtained to verify and record the identity of „occasional clients“ (those without accounts), when undertaking a one-off transaction in excess of GH¢20,000.00. All prospective customers shall be vetted.

A. PERSONAL CUSTOMER

Where a person (s) applies to open a personal account, joint account or sole proprietorship account, reasonable steps must be taken to ascertain that the customer is whom he/she purports to be. We need to verify:-

- True identity of the person (s)
- Occupation
- Correct postal address including residential (this may be sketched or described if necessary with major landmarks annotated)
- Date of birth of the person (s)
- Purpose of the account

- Likely source of funds/wealth

Likely turnover

The required as prescribed in our account opening mandatory documentation need to be adhered to as follows:

B. INDIVIDUAL/JOINT ACCOUNT

- Completed Customer Information Sheet (account opening form) & Mandate form for Joint accounts
- Specimen signature card
- Two (2) recent colour passport size pictures
- Valid Passport, Driver License, Voter ID, and National ID
- Copy of Utility Bill (Electricity or Water). This is still relevant even if the bill is not in the name of the customer since it confirms the house address. In the absence of this, physical location and major landmarks shall be sketched and verified. The idea is to be able to physically locate the person. Employees shall be mindful to annotate the local names used by the person in the locality. For example, Mr. Owusu known as “Bossman”. Mrs. Appiah known as “Ataa Maame”.
- Letter from employer if applicable
- Foreigners in addition to the above should make available Immigration Clearance/Resident permit as appropriate
- For students a letter of introduction from institution signed by an authorized person

C. SOLE PROPRIETORSHIP

- The Banks’ Customer Information Sheet (account opening form)
- Certificate of Registration
- Form A, details of owner showing registration of business name

- Registration receipt (current year)
- Specimen Signature Card
- Passport or Driver license of proprietor and/or agents appointed under third party arrangements, e.g., Power of Attorney
- Two (2) recent colour passport size photograph of proprietor
- Copy of utility bill (electricity or water) of proprietor and/or other signatories under a third party arrangement.
- An introduction from a respected and known customer(s). Member(s) of staff may assist verification **but this does not**

remove the need for positive identification procedures or address verification to be carried out

- Where a member of staff encounters difficulty in verifying identity or address of the applicant he/she shall refer the matter to a higher authority who shall seek clearance in accordance with this policy
- Copies of any document that are presented by a prospective client/customer shall be produced and filled with the account opening documents. **The account opening official shall initial all photocopies stating that the original document has been sighted**
- ARB shall discourage the operation of “Hold Mail” accounts. This usually arises when statements of accounts are returned by the postal authorities because the stated addresses cannot be traced. A suitable check shall be made immediately there is any further activity on the account to establish the genuineness of the transaction and the account holder’s new address
- For those prospective customers who are not normally resident in Ghana, identification should be established in the normal manner. However, for example, most European and American customers often use street addresses rather than postal addresses and this will also be the case for a number of other overseas customers. In such cases confirmation of the street address should be sought from sighting utility bills or bank statements from their present bankers outside the country.

With respect to foreign nationals working in the country, verification of the income tax registration number must be made against the document issued by the Ghana Revenue

Authority which bears the person's tax identification number (TIN). Their immigration status and work permit shall also be inspected.

D. LEGAL PERSONS (CORPORATE CUSTOMERS)

- Where an application is made to open a company account by a company registered in Ghana or elsewhere, the following document or local equivalent shall be obtained:
 - i. The original or certified copy of the Certificate of Incorporation and Certificate to Commence Business or its equivalent;
 - ii. The Company Regulations/Memorandum and Articles of Association or its equivalent.
 - iii. A Resolution of the Board of Directors to open an account and authority conferred on those who will operate the account;
 - iv. Latest Audited Accounts;
 - v. Two (2) recent colour passport size photograph of directors/signatories and
 - vi. A Power of Attorney executed under seal, in the case of foreign companies, naming authorized agents and the extent and levels of authority.

Where the applicant is a private company, care should be taken to verify the legal existence of the company. The extent of the identification measures required depends on the nature of the company. The identity of a corporate body comprises the following:

- The company registration number
- The corporate name and any trading names used
- The registration address or any separate principal trading address
- The names of the directors
- Identification procedures should be carried out in respect of the directors who are principal controllers of the company. Typically, these would be those shareholders that control 20% of the shareholding, the company's directors and those mandated to manage the company's accounts that would be in position to override internal procedures and control mechanisms
- The nature of the company's business
- Company Regulation/Memorandum and Articles of Association

- Where the company is a public company quoted on a recognized stock exchange, it is considered that these companies are publicly owned and generally accountable. Consequently, it is not considered necessary to identify all the shareholders.
- Where the account is being opened for a state institution, confirmation should be sought from the Head of the institution concerned. Signatories to the account should be made to appear in person for verification of their identity.

E. ONE-OFF TRANSACTION

Special care and vigilance shall be required where a prospective customer/client or a person who does not have an account with the Bank requests a transaction to be carried out. **HOWEVER, PAYMENTS MADE IN CASH ON BEHALF OF NON-CUSTOMERS OR WALK-IN CUSTOMERS CONSTITUTE A HIGHER RISK SO EXTRA DUE DILIGENCE SHALL BE UNDERTAKEN TO ASCERTAIN THE SOURCE.** Positive evidence for identity shall be obtained and the procedure required in the case of a personal customer who wishes to open an account shall be followed. Any large credit received for a customer, if considered out of context with that customer's normal banking, shall be referred to the AML Reporting Officer.

- Every transaction or series of transactions shall be considered in the light of the knowledge of the customer's account and knowledge of what kind of transactions might be suspicious
- A one-off transaction payment or electronic transfer from the customer's own account or a transfer from a customer's connected account may be exempted from the vetting procedures referred to above
- A written assurance from agents or institutions subject to the AML/CFT Regulations or an introduction by a recognized Ghanaian, or Foreign Finance Institution may exempt a customer from the identification procedures laid out above
- No exemptions shall be available if there is any knowledge or suspicion of money laundering

F. CLUBS, SOCIETIES AND CHARITIES

- Where an account is to be opened for clubs, societies and charities, the account opening officer shall satisfy himself as to the legitimate purpose of the organization.
- A copy of the constitution or club rules and regulations of the prospective club, society or charity must be obtained
- Identification of the operators of the account shall be obtained as pertains with individuals
- At the account opening stage, information shall be obtained on the level of funding
- Two (2) recent colour passport size photographs of trustees or signatories

8.0 MONITORING EXISTING CLIENT ACCOUNTS (CONTINUOUS DUE DILIGENCE)

It is possible that existing clients may become involved in money laundering, wittingly or unwittingly. Laundering can take place through cash deposits, transfers in, transfers out and through lending. It is, therefore, vital that the Bank is vigilant and that all out of line or unusual transactions are identified and investigated.

9.0 DEPOSITS

A Limit of GH¢19,999.99 is being applied for personal and corporate deposits. Where accounts deposited are over and above this then there is the need to establish whether a deposit, cash or non-cash is typical for the customer in question. A Cash Transaction Report (CTR) is to be sent to the FIC on the transaction.

Please note that third party depositors of funds are to be properly identified.

10.0 PAYMENTS

Payment transactions include cash withdrawals and transfers. The same limits are to be applied as for deposits and a CTR sent to the FIC

11.0 ADVANCES

Granting and settlement of client loans must be monitored. Any suspicion of money laundering shall be reported to the AMLRO. The following should be noted:

- Where the legitimacy of the client during the „normal due diligence“ procedure is in doubt.
- The use of the loan is unusual for the clients“ business.
- The origin of assets being offered for security is unclear.

The following situations call for enquiry:

- Any repayment out of line with the original agreement, e.g. early settlement of the facility.
- Any unexpected settlement of an overdue position.
- Any settlement from a previously unknown and unrelated source/account.
- Any deviations from previously submitted cash flows.
- Where turnover figures appear inconsistent with the nature of the business and the advance granted.

12.0 RECOGNISING SUSPICION

The types of transactions, which may be used by a money launderer, are almost unlimited.

A suspicious transaction will often be one that is inconsistent with a customer“s known legitimate business or personal activities or with the normal business for that type of company.

The following are examples of what might constitute suspicious transaction but are not limited to the under-mentioned transactions. These should prompt enquiry.

A. MONEY LAUNDERING USING CASH TRANSACTIONS

- Unusually large cash deposits made by an individual or company whose business activity would normally be generated by cheques and other instruments.

- Substantial increase in cash deposit of any individual business without apparent cause, especially if such deposits are subsequently transferred within a short period out of the account and/ or to a destination not normally associated with the customer.
- Customers who deposit cash by means of numerous credit slips so that the total of each individual deposit is insignificant, but the aggregate of all the credits is significant.
- Company accounts whose transactions, both deposits and withdrawals, are done in cash rather than the forms of debit and credit normally associated with commercial operations, e.g., cheques, letters of credits, etc
- Customers who constantly pay in cash to cover request for bankers' draft, money transfers or other negotiable and readily marketable money instruments.
- Customers who seek to exchange large quantities of low denomination notes for those of higher denominations.
- Frequent exchange of cash into other currencies.
- Customers transferring large sums of money to and from overseas locations with instructions for payment in cash.
- Large cash deposits using night safe facilities, thereby avoiding direct contact with bank staff

B. MONEY LAUNDERING USING BANK ACCOUNTS

- Customers who wish to maintain a number of trustee clients' accounts, which do not appear consistent with the type of business, including transactions, which involve nominee names.
- Customers who have numerous accounts and pay in cash to each of them under circumstances in which, the total credit would be a large amount.
- Any individual or company whose account shows no normal personal banking or business related activities, but is used to receive or disburse large sums, which have no obvious purpose or relationship to the account holder and/or his business.

- Reluctance to provide normal information when opening an account; providing information that is difficult or expensive for the bank to verify.
- Customers who appear to have accounts with several financial institutions within the same locality, especially when the bank is aware of a regular consolidation process from such accounts prior to a request for onward transmission of the funds.
- Matching of payment out with credits in by cash on the same or previous day.
- Paying large third party cheques endorsed in favour of the customer.
- Large cash withdrawals from a previously dormant/inactive account, or from an account which has just received an unexpected large credit from abroad.
- Customers who together, and simultaneously, use separate tellers to conduct large cash transactions or foreign exchange transactions.
- Greater use of safe deposit facilities. The use of sealed packets deposited and withdrawn
- Companies' representatives avoiding contacts with the branch
- Substantial increases in deposits of cash or negotiable instruments by a professional firm or company, using client accounts or in house company or trust account, especially if the deposits are promptly transferred between other client company and trust accounts
- Large number of individuals making payments into the same account without an adequate explanation

D. MONEY LAUNDERING BY SECURED AND UNSECURED LENDING

- Customers who repay problem loans unexpectedly.
- Request to borrow against assets held by the bank or a third party, where the origin of the asset is not known or the assets are inconsistent with the customer's borrowing.

- Request by a customer for a bank to provide or arrange finance where the source of the customer's financial contribution to the deal is unclear, particularly where property is involved.

13.0 REPORTING SUSPICIOUS TRANSACTIONS

It is the duty of every member of Management and staff to report suspicious transactions or other suspicious transactions relating to money laundering, to the Anti-Money Laundering Reporting Officer (AMLRO). All suspicions shall be submitted in an appropriate format (appendix) to the Anti-Money Laundering Reporting Officer.

The report shall include

- Name of the reporting member of staff and department
- Full details of the customer
- A brief but concise statement of events giving rise to the suspicion, accompanied with any original (or copy) documentation
- Date when the member of staff first received the information and became suspicious and the
- Date of the report

The report must be signed by the person with the suspicion

14.0 THE ANTI-MONEY LAUNDERING REPORTING OFFICER (AMLRO)

- a) The Board/Management shall appoint an Anti-Money Laundering Reporting Officer (AMLRO) and this appointment shall be communicated to every member of staff in writing.
- b) The AMLRO shall be expected to act honestly and reasonably and make his/her recommendations in good faith
- c) The AMLRO shall have an unqualified access to all information that will enable him/her to undertake his/her responsibilities
- d) The AMLRO shall receive all reports of suspicion in the Suspicious Transaction Report form (appendix)

- e) The AMLRO shall acknowledge receipt and at the same time provide a reminder of the obligations to do nothing or say anything that may prejudice the enquiry. The AMLRO or a member of staff who reports a suspicion shall not inform a suspected person or any third party, that a disclosure has been made or is about to be made or that the authorities are acting or about to act in connection with an investigation. This would be deemed “tipping off”. The AMLRO shall maintain a log and keep written records of every matter reported to him/her.
- f) The AMLRO shall be required to evaluate the substance of the suspicion by way of a confidential enquiry within the bank. The AMLRO is not required to make enquires outside the bank. However, if deemed necessary the AMLRO may enquire of the customer discreetly outside of the bank or request an appropriate person to do so.
- g) In evaluating the substance of the suspicion, the AMLRO shall take the following into consideration:
- Type of business or pattern of business
 - Length of business relationship
 - Transaction patterns
 - Volume of business
 - Source and destination of funds

 - Existence of earlier suspicion
 - Referral to identification records held
- h) All documents called for by the AMLRO as part of the enquiry shall be listed and copies retained. After making the enquiry, the AMLRO shall decide whether or not to make a disclosure to the Financial Intelligence Centre through the Chief Compliance Officer (CCO).
- i) The AMLRO shall secure copies of the document from the enquiries undertaken and the reasoning behind the decision.

- j) Where the suspicion is an “open and shut case” the AMLRO shall report it immediately, explaining in the disclosure that no further enquiry was considered.
- k) Disclosure of a suspicion must be considered and documented without delay and the AMLRO shall ensure that the disclosure reports provide as much information with regard to the suspicion detailing the full story or as much as is known and should include”-
 - Information and suspicion initially reported to the AMLRO
 - Enquiries undertaken by the AMLRO
 - AMLRO’s reasoning for the disclosure
- l) The AMLRO shall ensure the following records are retained and stored securely for a minimum of 6 years:
 - Record of suspicion raised internally whether disclosed to the Financial Intelligence Centre or not
 - The AMLRO’s own “suspicion evaluation record”
 - A record of training undertaken for members of staff and signed off by the AMLRO and a higher authority with dated indication:
 - Nature of training given and
 - Names of staff attending or receiving training
 - At least twice (2x) in a year, the AMLRO will produce a report for Senior Management and the Board.
 - The AMLRO shall ensure that the bank’s obligations and members of staff compliance with the provisions under Act 749 is without question.

15.0 REPORTING TO THE FINANCIAL INTELLIGENCE CENTRE (FIC)

- A. The AMLRO shall within 24 hours submit a suspicious transaction report (STR) to the FIC, after having knowledge of or the ground for suspicion of a transaction and for a transaction to be linked to or used for the financing of a terrorist act as defined by the laws, for a reporting format as may be determined by the FIC from time to time)

*The **FIC** is the body established under Act 2008, (Act 749) to amongst others assist in the identification of proceeds of unlawful activity and the combating of money laundering activities.*

- B. The particulars of electronic transfer and receipt of currency outside the country subject to the Foreign Exchange Act 2006, (Act 723) which exceeds the amount prescribed by the Bank of Ghana shall within 24 hours after the transaction be reported to the FIC.

16.0 RISK THRESHOLD/CASH TRANSACTION REPORT (CTR)

All deposits of GH¢20,000.00 (Twenty thousand Ghana cedis) and above whether by cash or cheque are to be referred to a designated officer before acceptance by the Cashiers. The officer will initial the deposit slip if they consider it bona fide. However, a Cash Transaction Report is to be made to the FIC through the AMLRO on all cash transactions GH¢20,000.00 and above.

17.0 DURATION OF RECORD KEEPING

- A. Copies of all account opening documentation or relationship records must be kept for a minimum of six (6) years after the banker/customer relationship is terminated.
- B. Records of all transactions including foreign money transfers must be kept for a minimum period of six (6) years after the date of the transaction.

18.0 CUSTOMER IDENTIFICATION AND RECORD KEEPING REQUIREMENT FOR MONEY TRANSFER (MT) SERVICES

- A. Adequate knowledge of the client is checking his identity and address, through the requirement of presentation of an original document as valid.
The presentation of an authentic and valid Identification Document is preliminary to the execution of any Money Transfer. Consequently,

employees are required to review customer identification and ensure that:

- It is Authentic
- It is Currently valid

- It is issued by Government
- It Contains a photograph
- It Contains Customer's names
- It Contains Customer's address (Preferred)

B. Members of staff shall determine if the form of identification is acceptable by local regulations and Western Union/MoneyGram Policies.

Example of acceptable forms of identification may include the following:

- National ID Card
- Passport
- Driver license
- Voter ID Card
- Residential work permit
- NHIS ID Card

C. Maximum attention shall be given to ensure that the true identity of a customer is established

If one or several of the preceding conditions are not fulfilled or if the customer refuses to give the necessary information, members of staff shall refuse the transaction.

If the conditions are fulfilled, members of staff shall record on the Send or Receive forms of the Customer as well as the operation software:

- Name,
- Date of Birth,
- Address,
- Type of Identification Document presented, •
Document number and issuer

Members of staff shall ensure that the client signs the form of the transaction and files it in accordance with bank's policy. Furthermore, as demanded by the regulations of the country operators shall also attach to the signed form, a copy of the identity of the client.

If the transaction amount is above 7,500 USD or its equivalent, employees have to call the particular Money Transfer (MT) Service Center in order to have its approval.

19.0 DETECTION OF MONEY TRANSFER SUSPICIOUS TRANSACTION AND SUSPICIOUS ACTIVITY REPORT

A. DETECTION OF SUSPICIOUS TRANSACTION

Members of staff shall be extremely vigilant in order to identify potential suspicious transactions/behaviors.

B. DETECTION BY FRONT LINE STAFF (FLS)

FLS have to pay attention to Customers' behavior. The following points are examples of warning signs of potential suspicion.

C. SUSPICIOUS BEHAVIOUR:

- Customer presenting doubtful or falsified ID
- Too much in a hurry, nervous or evasive
- Aggressive and refuses to cooperate
- Refusing to provide elements needed in justifying the transaction when this is requested by the FLS
- Try to avoid answering relevant questions and rather promising to ensure large volumes of transfers are effected through the bank
- Attempting to corrupt the FLS in order to avoid certain record keeping requirements
- Give incoherent and inconsistent information

D. SUSPICIOUS TRANSACTIONS:

- Disproportionate compared to the usual transactions undertaken by the customer or compared to the trend of transactional activities
- Transaction amount or frequency is too high for the account history

- No apparent or legitimate relationship exists between the sender and receiver
- Series of transactions which are slightly lower than the prescribed reporting thresholds
- Operated by customers who seem to know each other but which makes pretense of the opposite

20.0 TREATMENT OF SUSPICIOUS TRANSACTIONS

A. FRONTLINE STAFF (FLS) REQUIREMENT

FLS takes care of the regularity and the conformity of Money Transfer transactions compared to the AML and KYC standards.

For this reason, when an FLS suspects a transaction being irregular compared to Government regulations and to the Money Transfer company as well as standards in the industry, the member of staff shall question the customer on the following elements:

- (i) Transaction purpose
- (ii) The nature of the customer's relationship with the sender/receiver
- (iii) Eventual supporting documents when it comes to large aggregated transaction amounts etc.

If the Suspicion is confirmed or if the FLS does not manage to obtain additional information allowing him to clarify the customer's behavior, a declaration of suspicion is transmitted to the Compliance Officer

This declaration must contain at least the following elements:

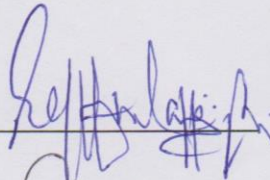
- The Customer(s) object of the declaration data (Name, ID Number, address...)
- List of suspicious transaction identified
- An explanatory comment of reasons for the suspicion
- Eventual supporting document collected from the Customer

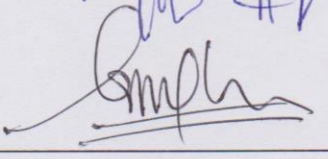
The principle governing the activities of members of staff in the reporting is as follows:

- When in doubt, consult the AML compliance officer for advice
- When suspicious at the branch, file a report to the AMLRO

All documents used in connection with these declarations and investigations shall be reported to the compliance officer.

Approved:

GEORGE KWASI DWARE 
Chairman, BOD

Samuel NIBIR 
General Manager

Nurann Sackey Mensah 
Head, Banking Operations

EFFECTIVE DATE OCTOBER 2017